UNREEL README

Project Members: Pranav Gunhal, Wilson Lau, Karthik Jandhyala

Target Audience:
The value proposition for Unreel is to help young adults who want to reduce their social media usage.

Value Proposition:
Existing screen-time tools feel isolating and easy to ignore and there is little social accountability in those current solutions. Unreel transforms screen-time reduction into a shared, competitive experience by allowing friends to set goals, create challenges, and track progress together.

Setup and Access:
You can access the Unreel's medium-fi prototype through Figma using this link.

Intended Device:
Unreel is designed to run on mobile smartphone devices because it's the most common medium for people to waste time on social media. This particular prototype was designed with the design specifications of an iPhone 17. For the medium-fi prototype, however, we recommend that users test this with a laptop for ease of navigation.

Context:
Unreel is intended to be useful to address a user's social media addiction by using real-world connections as a bulwark to mindless scrolling. Based on our task flows and designed features, we aim for our user to be able to do the following steps:

- **Manage Group Challenges:**
  Users must be able to view their active challenges and easily choose to accept or decline challenge requests from their friends. They can also create their own custom group challenges modeled after existing personal goals, select specific friends to add to the challenge, and set the challenge leaderboard to either public or private.

- **Create and Edit Personal Goals:**
  Users can establish personal limits for specific apps, such as "No Instagram". When creating a goal, they can customize aspects like the target time, the specific apps included, the strictness level, and the types of messages they receive.

- **Track Stats and Leaderboards:**
  Users can view their personal usage statistics to track specific distractions and gain personalized insights for improvement. They can also access an interactive leaderboard to view top users and compare their personal stats against their friends.

Prototype Operation:

- **General:**
  There are a few key functions of Figma that support our prototype. To start, only features highlighted are interactable (shown in the Images section). The rest are elements that haven't been implemented yet. <u>Also, the tasks must be done from simple to complex (in that order) in order for the UI to function properly.</u>

- **Simple Task (Accepting/Declining challenges):**
  1. Starting on the home screen, the user will click on the menu bar and press the button to navigate to the Challenges page (the icon of it is a lock).
  2. The user will see hard-encoded invitations from their friend group asking to join them on a social media challenge, like "Stop using reels".
  3. The user will first accept Jacob's invitation by pressing the Yes button (check mark), then reject Maria's invitation by pressing the No button (x mark).

- **Moderate Task (Creating a new goal):**
  1. Starting on the home screen, the user will either press the Add button on the Your Goals section of the Home page or they can click on the menu bar and press the Insights button (the icon of it is similar to a stock ticker graph going upwards). Either one of these actions will take the user to the Insights page.
  2. Click on the grey Add button to make a new goal.
  3. Fill out the details on making a goal from top to bottom (the details are hard-coded and the full flow is described in Hard-Coded Items) and click 'Add goal'.

- **Complex Task (Create a custom challenge from a goal):**
  1. Use the menu bar to navigate to the Challenges page.
  2. Click on the grey Add button to create a new challenge.
  3. Fill out the details on making a goal from top to bottom (the details are hard-coded and the full flow is described in Hard-Coded Items) and click 'Add challenge'.
     a. Name the challenge, model it after an existing goal from the dropdown, add friends to the challenge, set the leaderboard to public, and create the challenge.

Prototyping Tools:

The prototype was primarily built using Figma for the prototype design and the general wireframing of the app. Some images were sourced from Google, and all other icons, buttons, etc. were created within Figma.

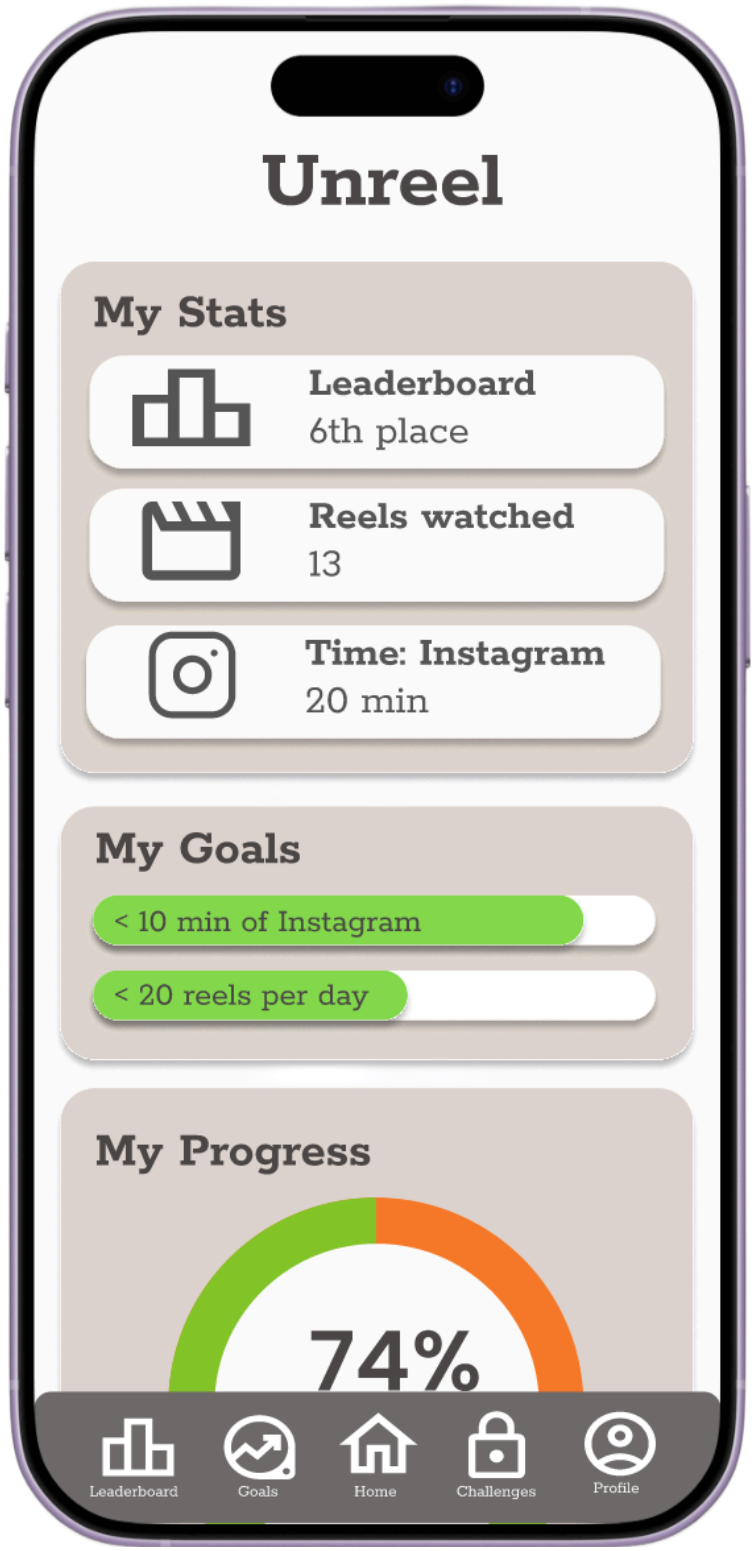
Limitations:
Due to Figma's constraints and the nature of the med-fi prototype, we had some limitations with how we had to design our prototype.

1. The user can't actually test making/joining a friend group, along with receiving notifications/messages from other users.
2. No actual app blocking. Unreel's core functionality, which is blocking social media apps, requires OS-level permissions that can't be simulated in Figma. Right now the prototype communicates this feature through hard-coded UI, so users can evaluate the interaction without experiencing the functionality

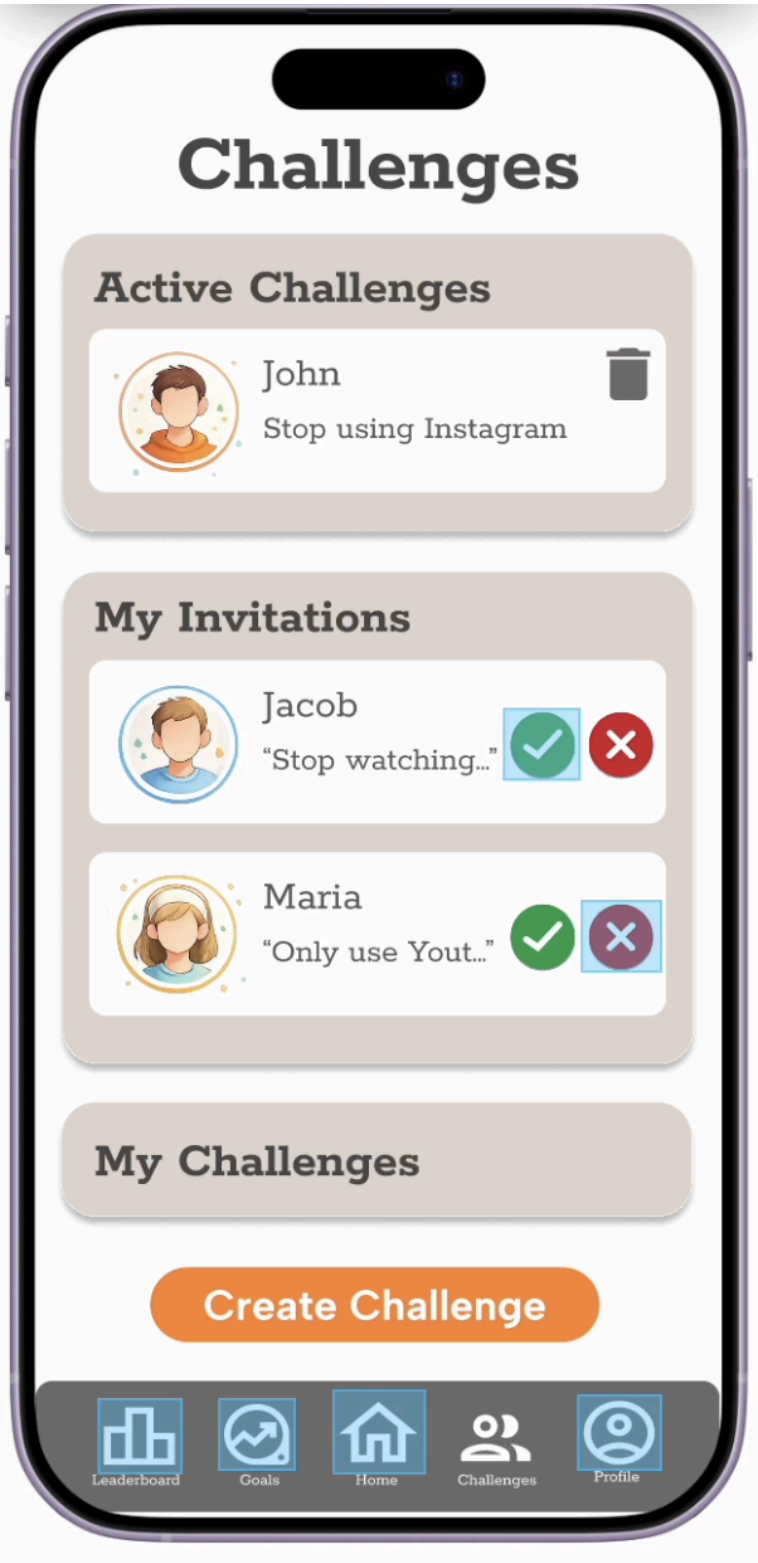
Hard-Coded Items:
To deal with some of Figma's limitations, we hard-encoded some aspects of the prototype for ease of implementation and general UI/UX testing. Each is justified below.

1. For our moderate and complex tasks, we hard-coded the flow so we could focus on testing the user experience.
    a. <u>Moderate Task Flow</u>: Name (just press enter after clicking on the element), Time = 1 month, Strictness = Hard, Apps = Facebook, Messages = 1/day. Hard-coded so task UX can be tested with making it fully functional yet.
    b. <u>Complex Task Flow</u>: Name (just press enter after clicking on the element), Details and People (Add John and Jacob to the challenge and import their challenge details), Leaderboard = Public. Hard-coded for the same reason as above.
2. <u>Friend group (John, Jacob, Maria):</u> Hard-coded because Figma cannot simulate a real friend graph. Three friends are sufficient to show friend-related interactions across the three tasks.
3. To simulate challenge notifications, we hard-coded some notifications to display for testing.
4. <u>Goals List:</u> Hard-coded goals because Figma cannot persist goals created previously. Three goals are appropriate for making the complex task dropdown meaningful.

Images:



Home Page



Blue highlights what can be clicked, while everything else isn't active/implemented.